

Blood Pressure - High - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1070 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- High blood pressure assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Clinical background

- High blood pressure usually causes no symptoms and must be confirmed with an appropriate blood-pressure measurement.
- Readings are generally considered high at 140/90 mmHg or higher in a clinical setting or 135/85 mmHg or higher at home.
- Untreated hypertension increases the risk of heart attack, stroke, heart failure, kidney disease, eye disease, and vascular dementia.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the adult's exact age and sex, are they pregnant or within 6 weeks postpartum, what readings were obtained, and were they repeated after rest with a validated device, correct cuff, supported bare arm, and no talking? Do not use this adult-only protocol for a child.
2. [YES_NO] Is the caller already being treated for high blood pressure?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] Any other symptoms right now (headache, chest pain, vision changes)?
4. [PREGNANCY] Is the patient pregnant or possibly pregnant? If yes, record gestation where known.

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Blood Pressure - Low

Is the current blood-pressure concern a low reading, faintness, or symptoms after standing rather than an elevated reading?

A low-pressure presentation is outside this high-blood-pressure guideline.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there chest pain or discomfort that does not go away, pain spreading to the arm/neck/jaw/back, or chest pain with sweating, nausea, lightheadedness, or breathlessness?

NHS.UK high blood pressure guidance lists these as call-999 criteria for a possible heart attack.

1. Disposition level 100

Is the patient pregnant or recently postpartum with severe headache, new visual disturbance, severe pain below the ribs or in the upper abdomen, seizure, confusion, collapse, severe breathing difficulty, or rapidly worsening severe illness?

NICE and RCOG identify severe headache, visual symptoms and severe upper-abdominal/rib pain in pregnancy or after birth as possible pre-eclampsia warning symptoms requiring immediate medical help. Qatar 999 is reserved here for immediate life-threatening or rapidly deteriorating features; exact maternity handover remains GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.

1. Disposition level 70

Is the patient pregnant or recently postpartum with a raised blood-pressure reading or new headache, visual symptoms, swelling, nausea/vomiting, or upper-abdominal discomfort, but none of the immediate life-threatening features above?

Pregnancy and postpartum hypertension require prompt maternity assessment because pre-eclampsia may first occur during pregnancy or after birth. Exact Qatar maternity destination, timing and transport remain GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.

1. Disposition level 70

Are there frequent headaches or blurred vision, or chest pain that comes and goes?

NHS.UK guidance recommends calling 111 for these symptoms alongside high blood pressure.

1. Disposition level 50

Is the reading 140/90 or higher (professional check) or 135/85 or higher (home check), with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance defines these as high blood pressure readings warranting a GP or pharmacy check and follow-up.

Advice

Qatar emergency high-blood-pressure response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive when a high reading accompanies chest/back pain, severe breathlessness, stroke signs, seizure, confusion, fainting, acute visual loss, or pregnancy/postpartum warning symptoms. Keep the person resting and do not repeatedly recheck, take extra doses, or use another person's medicine while waiting; a device reading must not delay symptom-based emergency care. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: chest/back pain or breathing difficulty; stroke signs, seizure, confusion, or visual loss; pregnancy/postpartum severe headache, visual symptoms, upper-abdominal pain, or collapse.

Emergency pregnancy/postpartum hypertension response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for seizure, collapse, confusion, severe breathing difficulty, reduced consciousness, or rapidly worsening severe pregnancy/postpartum symptoms. Keep the patient resting, do not allow self-driving, and do not give extra blood-pressure medicine unless directed by the approved maternity/emergency pathway. Provide pregnancy or birth date and symptoms during handover; exact maternity receiving service remains GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's

ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

- Call Back If: seizure, confusion, collapse, or reduced consciousness; severe breathing difficulty; rapidly worsening severe headache, visual disturbance, or upper-abdominal pain.

Urgent maternity blood-pressure assessment

- Arrange prompt same-day maternity assessment through the Qatar governance-approved pathway; do not route a pregnant or recently postpartum patient through routine adult blood-pressure follow-up. Do not self-adjust medication. Call 999 for seizure, collapse, confusion, severe breathing difficulty, reduced consciousness, or rapid deterioration. Exact destination and transport remain GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.
- Call Back If: severe or worsening headache; new visual symptoms or severe upper-abdominal/rib pain; seizure, confusion, collapse, breathing difficulty, or reduced consciousness.

Urgent blood pressure review

- Arrange same-day medical review through the approved Qatar pathway for these accompanying symptoms.
- Call Back If: chest pain develops; vision worsens.

Routine blood pressure follow-up

- For a non-pregnant adult who is not recently postpartum, arrange a primary-care or pharmacy blood-pressure check and follow-up through the approved Qatar pathway.
- Call Back If: chest pain, severe headache, or vision changes develop; pregnancy or recent postpartum status is identified.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive when a high reading accompanies chest/back pain, severe breathlessness, stroke signs, seizure, confusion, fainting, acute visual loss, or pregnancy/postpartum warning symptoms. Keep the person resting and do not repeatedly recheck, take extra doses, or use another person's medicine while waiting; a device reading must not delay symptom-based emergency care. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for seizure, collapse, confusion, severe breathing difficulty, reduced consciousness, or rapidly worsening severe pregnancy/postpartum symptoms. Keep the patient resting, do not allow self-driving, and do not give extra blood-pressure medicine unless directed by the approved maternity/emergency pathway. Provide pregnancy or birth date and symptoms during handover; exact maternity receiving service remains GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "High blood pressure (hypertension)", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/high-blood-pressure-hypertension/> (page last reviewed 19 July 2024)
- NICE, "Hypertension in pregnancy: diagnosis and management", <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng133/chapter/recommendations>
- Royal College of Obstetricians and Gynaecologists, "Pre-eclampsia", <https://www.rcog.org.uk/for-the-public/browse-our-patient-information/pre-eclampsia/>

Provenance

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